
How can we make this summary short, clear, and useful?
Word limit: short
No filler
1
2
3
Action for Today

What problem are we solving?

3 Hours (180 minutes) - Hour 1 (50 min): Comprehensive Concept Lecture & Live Demonstration - Hour 2 (50 min): Guided Hands-On Lab (Basic Exercise: 5-Constraint Summary Audit) - Hour 3 (50 min): Applied Business Challenge & Peer Debrief (Advanced Exercise: Bimodal Stakeholder Tone Calibration)

SITUATION

The problem

An unconstrained AI summary can be too long, vague, and hard to use. A manager needs a way to specify required content, forbidden filler, audience, tone, and length.

TARGET

Learning goal

Eliminate ambiguous phrasing and enforce strict negative and positive constraints on AI outputs.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Public Data Source

- US Small Business Administration (SBA) Business Guide (https://www.sba.gov/business-guide/manage-your-business) - Free public business operating guides and management guidelines.

BOUNDARY

Use the supplied facts

An unconstrained AI summary can be too long, vague, and hard to use. A manager needs a way to specify required content, forbidden filler, audience, tone, and length.

What students need to understand

Key explanations taken from the active session lesson.

CORE IDEA

The Power of Constraints in Executive Writing (15 min)

- Executives do not read long paragraphs. They scan for metrics, decisions, and deadlines. Generative AI naturally defaults to wordy, passive-voice prose. To make AI useful for leadership communication, managers must apply strict constraints that eliminate unnecessary words.

CORE IDEA

Positive vs. Negative Constraints (15 min)

- Positive Constraints (What to Include): Format (e.g., "Exactly 3 numbered bullet points"), Length (e.g., "Under 120 words"), Target audience (e.g., "Written for a first-time store manager"), Required data (e.g., "Must cite the $50 budget limit").
- Negative Constraints (What to Forbid): Explicitly banning corporate fluff, clichés, and buzzwords ("Do NOT use words like 'synergy', 'game-changer', 'delve', 'testament', or 'seamless'").

What students need to understand

Key explanations taken from the active session lesson.

CORE IDEA

Calibrating Tone for Stakeholders (10 min)

- Demonstrate how tone constraints alter vocabulary:
- CFO Tone: Quantitative, concise, risk-focused, zero adjectives.
- Frontline Employee Tone: Empathetic, direct, step-by-step, actionable.

CORE IDEA

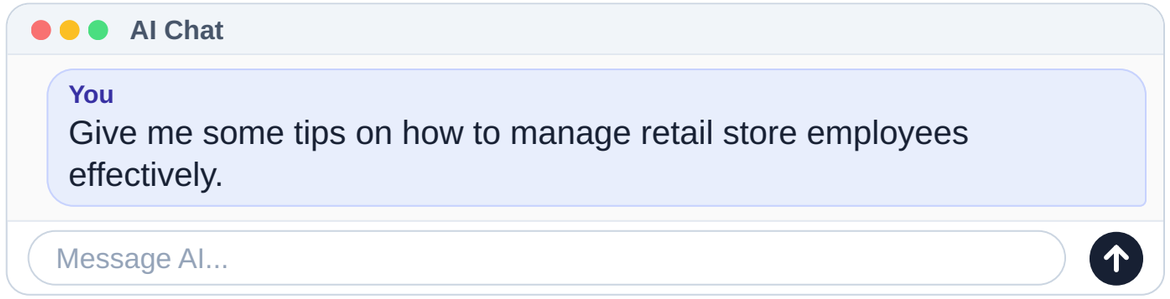
Instructor Live Demonstration Script & Discussion (10 min)

- Live Demo: Take a dense 400-word business operations policy from the SBA guide. Prompt ChatGPT without rules (producing 300 words of generic prose). Then prompt with 5 strict constraints. Count the words live on screen and show how negative constraints force crisp, high-density business communication. Discussion Question: "Why is it harder for AI to write under 100 words than over 500 words?" (Answer: Compressing ideas requires prioritization and omission, whereas expanding text aligns with the model's natural statistical verbosity).

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE



A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

You are a Retail Operations Consultant. Summarize the employee management guidelines below for a first-time store manager.

Follow these 5 strict constraints:
1. Maximum length: Exactly under 120 words total.
2. Format: Exactly 3 numbered bullet points, followed by one single "Action for Today".
3. Tone: Direct, operational, and practical (no academic jargon).
4. Negative Constraint: Do NOT use corporate buzzwords such as "synergy", "paradigm shift", "game-changer", "delve", or "testament".
5. Required Content: Every bullet must include a specific operational behavior (e.g., morning shift huddles, checklist sign-offs).

Source Guidelines:
"""
[Paste SBA guide excerpt here]
"""

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Scenario: Copy two paragraphs on employee management from the US Small Business Administration (SBA) guide.
- Task: Formulate and run a constrained prompt enforcing 5 strict rules: (1) Maximum 120 words, (2) Exactly 3 numbered bullets, (3) First-time manager tone, (4) Negative constraint banning buzzwords ("synergy", "game-changer"), and (5) One concrete action step.
- Deliverable: A rule checklist table marking Pass or Fail for each rule against the AI output.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Scenario: Using the exact same SBA employee management text from Exercise 1, your company must communicate this policy change to two contrasting stakeholder groups: the Chief Financial Officer and frontline hourly staff.
- Task: Engineer a single master prompt that ingests the SBA text and produces two distinct, tone-calibrated deliverables:
- Deliverable A (CFO Executive Brief): Strict 80-word ceiling, zero adjectives, quantitative, focused entirely on compliance cost and liability reduction.
- Deliverable B (Frontline Employee Guide): Step-by-step operational checklist written at an 8th-grade reading level, encouraging, clear, and focused on daily shift routines.
- Deliverable: Side-by-side comparison table showing both outputs and an analysis of how positive and negative constraints altered vocabulary choices.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W3_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Explain why an unconstrained summary is hard for a store manager to use.
- Method: Copy the unconstrained prompt, your 5-rule prompt (Exercise 1), and your master prompt for the CFO brief and frontline guide (Exercise 2).
- Results: Include a rule checklist table that marks Pass or Fail for each of the 5 rules. Add both Exercise 2 outputs side by side.
- Conclusion: Explain how the positive and negative constraints changed the vocabulary of the two outputs, and name the rule the AI found hardest to follow.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- ChatGPT will follow your rules closely, giving a concise answer without unnecessary extra text.